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Asciidoctor Installation and Configuration Guide

Release 1.0 First Edition Part number: E0426

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Chapter 1. Introduction

This guide explains how to install, verify, and configure Asciidoctor with PDF generation and a custom theme in VS Code.

Chapter 2. Prerequisites

List of software to install

1. Ruby
2. Asciidoctor
3. asciidoctor-pdf
4. VS Code AsciiDoc extension

Watch this video for installation guidance: Asciidoctor Markup Quick Start

Ruby 3.x is recommended for compatibility with Asciidoctor and PDF tooling.

Chapter 3. Installation

3.1. Step 1: Install Ruby

Download and install Ruby:

Ruby Downloads

- During installation, **uncheck** the MSYS install option.
- After installation, restart your terminal to ensure Ruby is added to the system PATH.

3.2. Step 2: Install Asciidoctor

Open **Windows PowerShell as Administrator** and run:

```
gem install asciidoctor ①
```

① Installs the core Asciidoctor processor.

3.3. Step 3: Install PDF support

Install the PDF backend:

```
gem install asciidoctor-pdf ①
```

① Enables PDF generation.

Verify prerequisites if needed: View prerequisites

3.4. Step 4: Optional dependencies

```
gem install concurrent-ruby ①
gem install coderay         ②
```

① Improves performance.

② Adds syntax highlighting (optional if using Rouge).

3.5. Step 5: Install VS Code extension

Install:

AsciiDoc VS Code Extension

Chapter 4. Verify Installation

```
ruby -v ①
asciidoctor -v ②
asciidoctor-pdf -v ③
```

① Confirms Ruby is installed.

② Confirms Asciidoctor is available.

③ Confirms PDF support is working.

If any command is not recognized, verify that Ruby is correctly added to the system PATH.

For additional diagnostics:

```
gem env ①
```

① Displays RubyGems environment details.

Chapter 5. VS Code Configuration (Custom PDF Theme)

This section configures VS Code to use a custom PDF theme.

5.1. Step 1: Clone the theme repository

```
git clone git@github.com:hotlanta/asciidoc_hcltech.git ①
```

① Contains theme and font files required for PDF styling.

If SSH is not configured, use HTTPS:

```
git clone https://github.com/hotlanta/asciidoc_hcltech.git
```

5.2. Step 2: Locate required files

From the repository:

- Theme file: `hcltech-theme.yml`
- Fonts directory: `fonts/`

Ensure all fonts referenced in the theme file exist in the fonts directory.

5.3. Step 3: Configure VS Code settings

Open VS Code → **Settings** → search for:
`Asciidoc: Pdf Command Args`

Add the following entries **individually**:

```
-a
pdf-theme=D:/path/to/asciidoc_hcltech/theme/hcltech-theme.yml

-a
pdf-fontsdir=D:/path/to/asciidoc_hcltech/fonts

-r
asciidoctor-pdf
```

① Each `-a` must be a separate entry.

② Paths must be absolute.

③ Use forward slashes / on Windows.

Do not combine arguments like:

```
-a pdf-theme=...
```

5.4. Step 4: Example configuration

```
-a
pdf-theme=D:/hotlanta_git/asciidoc_hcltech/theme/hcltech-theme.yml

-a
pdf-fontsdir=D:/hotlanta_git/asciidoc_hcltech/fonts

-r
asciidoctor-pdf
```

5.5. Step 5: Verify configuration

Generate a PDF in VS Code:

- Open `.adoc` file
- Press `Ctrl+Shift+P`
- Select: `AsciiDoc: Export document as PDF`

If configured correctly: - Custom theme is applied - Fonts render correctly - No warnings appear in the output

Chapter 6. Asciidoctor Upgrade

6.1. Update Asciidoctor

```
gem update asciidoctor ①
```

① Updates to the latest version.

6.2. Clean old versions

```
gem cleanup asciidoctor ①
```

① Removes outdated versions.

Chapter 7. Asciidoc editors

- AsciiDoc VS Code Extension
- AsciidocFX Editor
- Notepad++
- Any text editor

Chapter 8. AsciiDoc Syntax Reference

Official Documentation

Chapter 9. Troubleshooting

9.1. Commands not recognized

- Restart terminal
- Verify PATH configuration
- Reinstall Ruby if necessary

9.2. PDF not using theme

- Verify file paths
- Ensure arguments are separate
- Confirm theme file exists

9.3. Fonts not applied

- Check `pdf-fontsdir`
- Ensure fonts exist and are valid (TTF/OTF)

9.4. VS Code export fails

- Verify extension settings
- Restart VS Code
- Check output logs for errors